

Microsoft Word vs. Google Docs

A comprehensive, evidence-backed demonstration document

Positioning thesis

Word provides the real-time collaboration people expect from modern cloud editors while adding deep professional document production, formal review, rich desktop features, enterprise security, automatic accessibility, and file-format control.

Prepared for	Executive / Sales / IT decision-makers
Prepared by	Microsoft Word capability team
Date	2026-07-03
Document purpose	Prove “all they have plus more” with Word features embedded in this .docx
Status	Draft for review – use Track Changes and comments for sign-off

Table of Contents

Tip: In Word, right-click the Table of Contents and choose “Update Field” to refresh page numbers.

1. Executive summary

Microsoft Word should be positioned as the premium document platform: it matches the cloud collaboration benefits commonly associated with Google Docs, then extends beyond them with mature legal-grade review, long-document production, advanced layout, enterprise-grade protection, automation, accessibility and integration across Microsoft 365.

Capability	Google Docs expectation	Microsoft Word answer	Word advantage
Real-time coauthoring	Multiple users edit in a browser	Coauthoring in Word desktop/web when stored in OneDrive/SharePoint	Collaboration with desktop-grade layout and review controls
Comments & mentions	Comments, suggestions, action items	Threaded comments, @mentions, tasks, resolved threads	Integrated with Outlook/Teams/Microsoft 365 identity
Change review	Suggesting mode	Track Changes: insertions, deletions, formatting, reviewer identity, accept/reject, lock tracking	More formal review workflow for legal, editorial, regulated documents
Version history	Restore prior versions	Version history through OneDrive/SharePoint; local file versioning options	Cloud + enterprise repositories + recovery processes
Long documents	Headings, outline, basic TOC	TOC, captions, cross-references, indexes, bibliography, fields, master-document practices	Better for reports, contracts, manual theses
Formatting/design	Basic styles/tables/images	Advanced styles, themes, columns, section breaks, page setup, watermarks, object placement	Higher-fidelity professional output
Mail merge	Requires add-ons/workarounds	Native mail merge with Excel/Outlook data	Production-ready personalized letter labels, envelopes, email merges